



Asterisks

Asterisks are used to show that there is extra information at the bottom of the page. The extra information is known as a footnote. They are also used in newspaper articles when a direct quotation includes a word that is too offensive to be written in full. An asterisk represents each letter that has been omitted from the work. This reduces the word's impact, but it remains recognizable to readers who are familiar with it.

The asterisk leads the reader to a footnote explaining that the socks are low quality.

Free socks* will be included with all shoe orders.



- To mark the **omission of one or more words** from a passage, never use an asterisk; an **ellipsis (...)** should be used instead.

- If there is a need for **more than one footnote** on a page, use one **asterisk (*)** for the first footnote reference, and **two asterisks (**)** for the second, but do not use more than three in a sequence. In this case, numbering the footnotes would be a better option.

- When writing a **long Internet address** that breaks at the end of a line, break it after a slash—after “.com/” for example.



Pound signs

Found on every telephone keypad, the pound sign, also known as the number sign or hash, represents the word *number* in informal writing. It is usually preferable to write the word *number* instead.

It was the #1 fashion website in the world.

This means “number one.”

REAL WORLD

Twitter

The social networking service Twitter has adopted some of the less commonly used punctuation marks and given them a new significance. The at sign, for example, is used before someone's user name to mention or reply to that user, while the pound sign is used to add “tags” to words, making them searchable by other users.



- **Slashes** are found in certain abbreviations. For example, *c/o* appears in addresses and means “care of,” while *miles/hour* means “miles per hour.”

- The **ampersand (&)** should never be used in place of the word *and* in formal writing, nor should the **at sign** be used in place of the word *at*.